EDITION 2026 · US

Stop Blowing Funded Challenges

The Claude × TradingView
AI Risk Officer System

// Build the process between your emotions
// and your funded account.

MAKROMENTOR

Powered by Claude
Charts by TradingView
Built for the trader who's tired
of paying the fee twice.

CHAPTER

0. Disclaimer (read this first)

This playbook is educational. It is not financial advice, investment advice, a signal service, a managed account, an automated trading system, or a guarantee of trading results.

Trading futures, forex, crypto, equities, and prop firm challenges involves substantial risk of loss and is not suitable for every investor. Past performance is not indicative of future results. You can lose more than you deposit. You can fail every funded challenge you ever buy.

The Claude × TradingView workflow described in this book is a *decision framework* — a way of using a large language model and a charting platform to enforce your own process. Claude is an AI assistant. It does not place trades. It does not control your account. It does not predict the market. It can be wrong. You can override it. You are 100% responsible for every click, every position, every dollar of risk, and every rule violation on your prop firm dashboard.

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By reading further you accept full responsibility for your own outcomes.

CHAPTER

1. Manifesto: Stop Blowing Funded Challenges

You don't want another trading ebook.

You want to stop being the trader who blows the challenge after one bad trade.

You want to stop paying the reset fee. You want to stop opening a new account with a different prop firm and pretending it'll be different this time. You want to stop deleting the dashboard tab so your girlfriend can't see the red number.

You already know how to read a chart. That's not the problem. The problem is that between the chart and the click, there's nothing standing in your way. Just you. Tired you. Down-on-the-day you. "I have to make this back" you.

That trader doesn't deserve the keyboard. That trader is the reason every challenge dies in the third week.

What you need isn't another guru. Not another Discord. Not another indicator that's "different this time." Not another scaling plan you'll abandon by Wednesday.

You need a system that says **no** when your hands say yes.

That system is what this book builds. Claude reads the chart. Claude checks your stop. Claude checks your daily loss. Claude tells you the setup is dead. Claude doesn't care about your ego. Claude doesn't get tilted. Claude will never revenge-trade your account at 2:47 a.m.

You will still press the button. You will still take the loss. You will still wake up to red days. Nothing in this book stops the market from being the market.

But the next time your emotions try to walk you into a setup that has no business existing, something will stand between you and the click.

That's the dream. Not a winning bot. Not a $100K payout in your first month. Not a Lambo.

The dream is **control**.

The dream is logging off on a green day with your rules intact.

The dream is finishing a challenge — not because you got lucky, but because you didn't get unlucky enough to override your own system.

That's what's on the next 30 pages.

CHAPTER

2. The Funded Trader Dream

Everyone selling you a prop firm challenge sells you the wrong dream.

They sell you the payout screenshot. The $8,000 wire. The Discord pinned message. The orange-glow lifestyle reel.

That's not the dream. That's the souvenir.

The actual dream — the one you don't admit out loud — looks like this:

The dream is not more trades. The dream is fewer trades that you respect. You're not chasing a setup. You're not staring at the 1-minute waiting for confirmation that already passed. You opened TradingView at 9:25. You saw no edge. You closed the laptop at 9:31. You did not lose money today. That's the dream.

The dream is not staring at charts. The dream is knowing when to walk away. The most expensive seat at any prop firm is the one in front of an open chart with no setup. You don't need to "be present." You need to be honest. The dream is the lunch with your friend that you didn't cancel because "BTC is breaking out."

The dream is not predicting the market. The dream is a process you trust. You don't need to know what happens next. You need to know what you'll do when each thing happens. That's a different skill. That's the only skill this book teaches.

The dream is not the payout. The dream is the trade you didn't take. Every payout in trading is paid for by the trade somebody didn't take. The most profitable click of your career is the one you cancelled when your AI risk officer said no.

The dream is to stop being a prisoner of your emotions. You did not get into trading to feel like this. You got into trading because you wanted freedom. Freedom from a boss. Freedom from a commute. Freedom from a 9-to-5. And then trading became its own boss — louder, hungrier, and on call 24/7. The dream is to fire that boss too.

The dream is the identity. You don't want to be "a guy who trades." You want to be the operator who runs a process. That guy doesn't beg the market. The market is just data. He has rules. He has a desk. He has an officer at the gate. He's boring on purpose.

Your next payout — if it comes — starts there.

CHAPTER

3. Why Most Traders Don't Need Another Challenge

The fee won't fix it.

You already know this. You felt it the last time you clicked "Reset." There was a half-second between the click and the confirmation page where your stomach knew the next account was going to die the same way. Same emotions. Same hour of the day. Same revenge entry.

The next fee won't fix the same behavior.

A new firm won't fix the same behavior.

Smaller size won't fix the same behavior — it just slows the bleeding while raising your screen time.

Here's the honest list of why most retail traders never see a payout — and almost none of it is "strategy."

The seven killers

1. **No HTF context.** You enter on the 5-minute because it looks clean. You don't know if the 4H is in a trend, in a range, or post-impulse with no logical pullback zone. You're trading a screenshot, not a market.

2. **Revenge trading after a loss.** You took a clean loss. Process was respected. You should have closed the laptop. Instead you reopened the same chart looking for "one more A+." That trade is the one that ended your account.

3. **Random stop loss.** You set the stop where the loss "feels okay" — 1R from entry, or right under the wick. Not behind structure. Not behind a level that, if broken, kills the setup. The market hunts the obvious stop because the obvious stop is yours.

4. **No daily loss control.** The prop firm has a daily loss number. You know what it is. You don't know how close you are. You don't have a hard rule that says "at –40% of the daily loss, the laptop closes and I walk." So at –80% you're still clicking.

5. **Discord validation.** You posted the setup before entering. You got two green dots and a "looks good king." You took it because of the dots, not because of the chart. The dots don't pay your bills.

6. **Payout-screenshot chasing.** You scaled up to "make it worth it." You needed the trade to be worth $400, not $40. The dollar amount drove the size. The size killed the account.

7. **No process.** You don't have a written checklist. You don't have invalidation written down before you enter. You have *vibes* and *confluence*. The market eats vibes for breakfast.

If you read those seven and recognized four or more, the issue isn't the strategy.

The issue is that there's nothing between your emotions and your funded account.

That's what this book installs.

CHAPTER

4. Gambler vs Operator

There are two traders inside you.

You know both of them. They share a Discord username and a TradingView account. They take turns at the keyboard.

One of them keeps blowing the challenge.

The other one is the one you became this book for.

The Gambler

- Chases candles.
- Moves stops to give the trade “more room.”
- Revenge trades after a loss.
- Asks Discord if the setup is valid.
- Buys another challenge after a fail.
- Talks about the trade in the present tense even when the chart already invalidated.
- Has 14 indicators on the chart and reads none of them.
- Trades because the laptop is open.
- Counts winning trades, not respected rules.
- Has no idea where the daily loss number is right now.
- Believes the next setup will be different.

The Operator

- Checks HTF before LTF. Every time. Without exception.
- Writes the invalidation level *before* the entry.
- Calculates position size from the stop, not the other way around.
- Has a no-trade filter and uses it.
- Closes the laptop when the daily loss exceeds his soft limit.

- Doesn’t post setups before entering.
- Treats a respected loss as a green day.
- Has a checklist. Reads the checklist out loud. Catches himself lying on bullet 4.
- Calls his AI risk officer before he calls his bias.
- Counts the trades he didn’t take.
- Knows that the next challenge will fail the same way if he doesn’t change.

You’re not going to delete the gambler. He lives in your head rent-free. He’ll be there next week.

The point of this system is to make sure the gambler doesn’t reach the keyboard.

That’s the whole job of the AI Risk Officer.

> **Operator rule #1:** *Your ego wants the trade. Your process gets the final vote.*

CHAPTER

5. What the AI Risk Officer Actually Does

Let's get specific. I don't want you reading another 200 pages of metaphor.

The AI Risk Officer is not a bot. It is not a guru. It is not a signal service.

It is a Claude conversation — connected to your live TradingView chart via MCP — that you call **before** you place a trade, **during** a tilt moment, and **after** a loss.

It does five jobs.

Job 1: Check HTF before LTF

Before you enter on the 15M, the Risk Officer reads your 1D and 4H. If HTF is hostile, the LTF setup doesn't exist. End of conversation.

Job 2: Audit your stop

You give it your entry and your SL. It tells you whether the stop is logical — behind structure — or whether the stop is "wherever 1% fits." If it's the second one, the setup is rejected.

Job 3: Calculate position size from the stop

You give it your account size, your max risk per trade, and the SL distance. It calculates the position size. You do not move the stop to fit the position size. You move the position size to fit the stop. This is the single most important sentence in this book.

Job 4: Run the no-trade filter

It checks the kill list: - Is HTF context absent? - Is there a macro release in the next 30 minutes? - Are you already at the soft daily loss limit? - Was your last trade a loss in the last 20 minutes? - Are you trading outside your defined session? - Is the setup a chase after a 4R impulse with no retest?

If any of these are true, the response is the same: **NO TRADE**. No persuasion.

Job 5: Refuse to predict

The Officer does not say “BTC is going up.” The Officer says “Here’s the HTF context, here’s the LTF structure, here’s where the setup dies, here’s where it confirms, here’s the risk arithmetic, here’s the no-trade reason, here’s the decision: trade / wait / no trade.” That’s it. If you want a fortune cookie, buy a fortune cookie.

The Officer doesn’t press the button. It stops you from pressing the wrong one.

CHAPTER

6. Claude × TradingView: The System Architecture

You're going to set up four pieces of software. Once. Forever.

```
Claude → MCP Server → Chrome DevTools Protocol → TradingView Desktop
```

Claude (Desktop or Code)

This is the model. The reasoning layer. You'll talk to it in plain English. It can read your chart, it can read OHLCV data, it can read your indicators, it can write Pine Script, and it can refuse to give you a setup when you don't deserve one.

TradingView Desktop

The actual charting platform. Local app. Not the website. You need the desktop app because the bridge talks to the local Chromium debug port, not to a website.

MCP Server (Model Context Protocol)

Open-source. Runs on your machine. The translator between Claude and TradingView. You install it once. It exposes a set of "tools" Claude can call — read OHLCV, switch symbol, change timeframe, screenshot, run a health check, read indicators, work with Pine Editor.

Chrome DevTools Protocol

TradingView Desktop is an Electron app, which is Chromium under the hood. We launch it with `--remote-debugging-port=9222` so the MCP server can read what's on the chart.

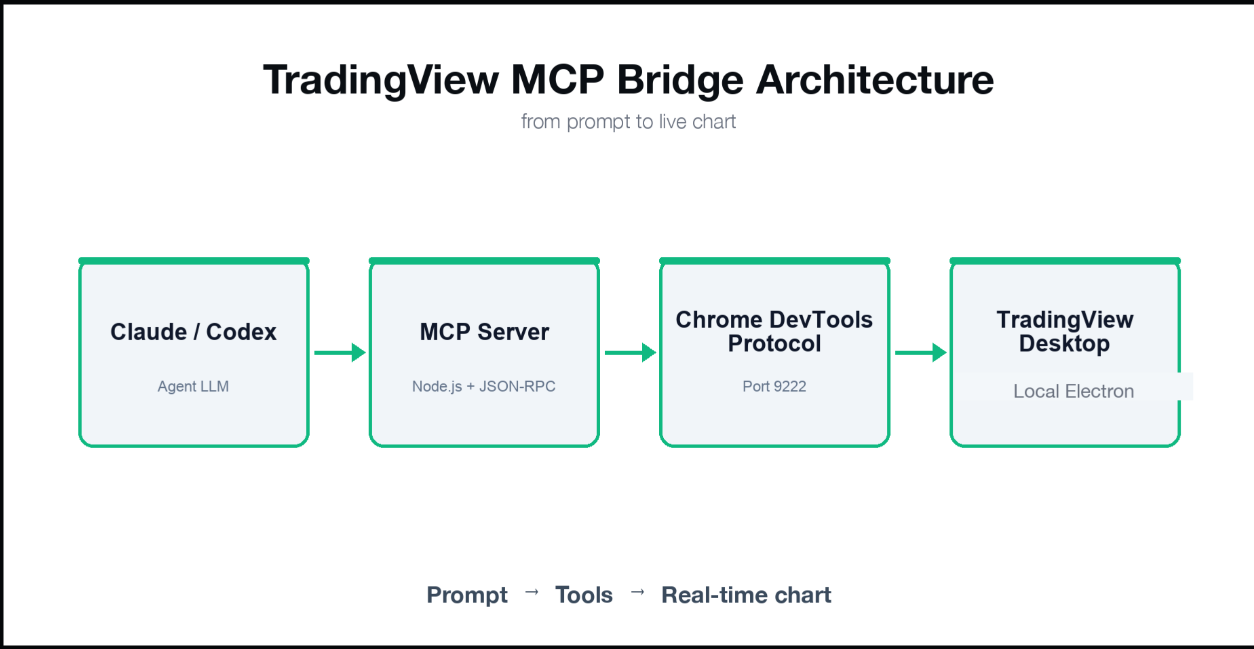

Figure 1. The full chain from prompt to live chart. Each node is a process on your local machine.

> **Important:** *The MCP bridge does not place trades, does not connect to your broker, does not know your prop firm password, and does not bypass paywalls. It reads what's on your logged-in chart. That's it.*

What Claude can do through MCP

- Read the current symbol and timeframe.
- Switch symbol or interval.
- Pull OHLCV data.
- Read indicator values.
- Read Pine Script outputs (lines, labels, tables, boxes).
- Take a screenshot of the chart.
- Open Pine Editor, paste code, check compile errors.
- Work with alerts and replay.

What Claude should NOT do

- Make a decision for you.

- Place a real trade.
- Touch your passwords or seeds.
- Install random repos without you reading the README.
- Run on a port exposed to the public internet.

CHAPTER

7. TradingView MCP Setup

There are three install paths. All three end at the same working setup. Pick one.

Requirements

- TradingView Desktop (installed and logged in).
- Node.js 18 or newer.
- One of: Claude Desktop (with connector), Claude Code, or Codex.
- A terminal. Yes, even on Mac.
- The ability to copy a file path.

The repo

We're installing this: `https://github.com/tradesdontlie/tradingview-mcp`

> *Read the README. Read the SECURITY notes. MCP gives an AI agent access to tools on your computer. Only install repos you trust. Only run the TradingView debug port locally, only when you need it.*

Path A — Claude Desktop Connector (fastest, lowest friction)

The built-in connector is called **"Control your Mac"** on macOS and **"Windows MCP"** on Windows. Both are official and signed by Anthropic — look for the green *Official* badge.

1. Install Claude Desktop from `claude.ai/download`.
2. Open Claude Desktop → **Settings** (`⌘+,` on Mac, `Ctrl+,` on Windows) → **Connectors** → **+ Add connector**.
3. Pick "Control your Mac" / "Windows MCP." Install.

4. Approve the system permissions Claude requests. Approve them one at a time. You can reject anything you're not comfortable with.
5. Open a new chat. Paste this exact prompt:

```
Install the TradingView MCP server. Clone https://github.com/tradesdontlie/
tradingview-mcp.git,
run npm install, add it to my MCP config at ~/.claude/.mcp.json, and launch
TradingView with
the debug port. Then verify the connection with tv_health_check.
```

Claude will narrate every command and ask you to approve each one. That's the whole install. Five minutes.

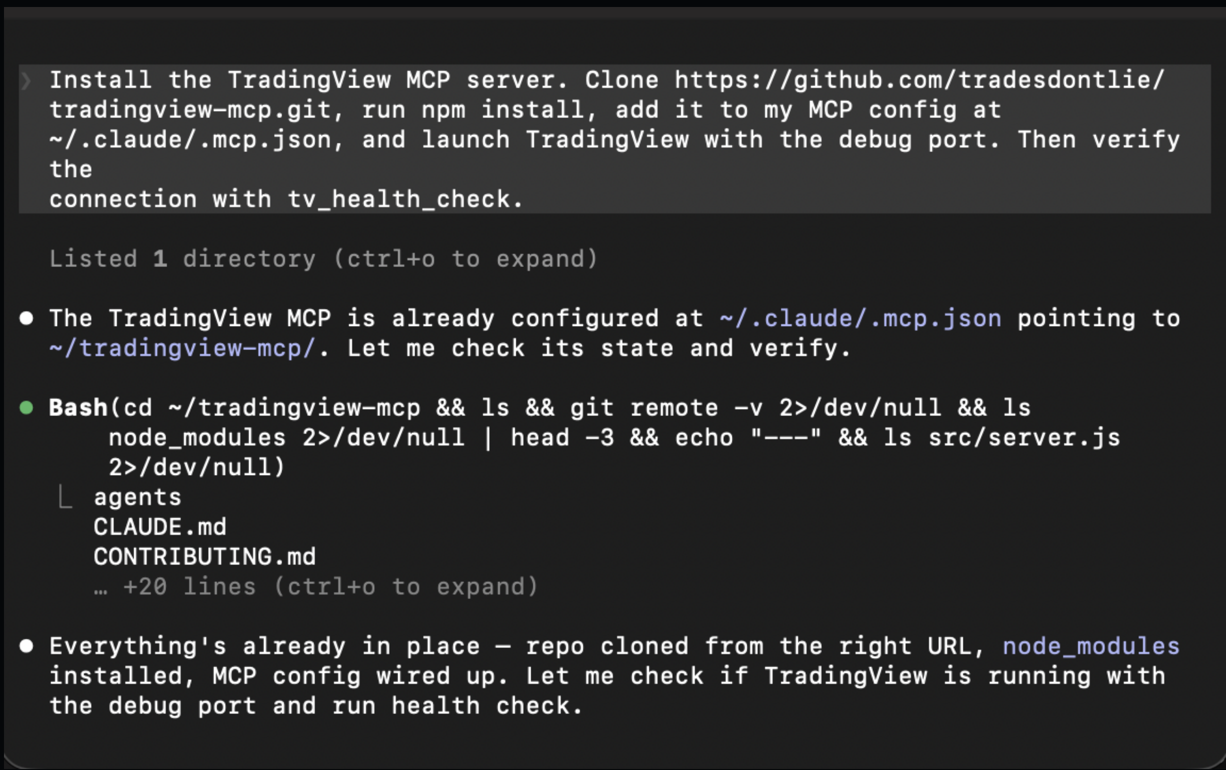

Figure 2. The same prompt running in Claude Code — every command is shown and confirmed before execution. Identical behavior in Claude Desktop with the Mac/Windows connector, and in Codex.

Path B — Claude Code (or Codex) in the terminal

Claude Code and Codex both have built-in terminal access — no connector needed. Open Claude Code in your home directory and paste the same prompt above. It'll clone, install, write the config, and run the health check.

If it fails, follow up with:

```
Use tv_health_check to verify TradingView is connected. If it fails, inspect the MCP config,
confirm the repo path, check Node.js version, and tell me the exact next fix.
```

Path C — Manual (for people who want to see every line)

```
cd ~
git clone https://github.com/tradesdontlie/tradingview-mcp.git
cd tradingview-mcp
npm install
```

Launch TradingView with the debug port:

Mac: `./scripts/launch_tv_debug_mac.sh` **Windows:** `scripts\launch_tv_debug.bat`
Linux: `./scripts/launch_tv_debug_linux.sh`

MCP config for Claude Code (`~/.claude/.mcp.json`):

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "tradingview": {
      "command": "node",
      "args": ["/Users/YOUR_NAME/tradingview-mcp/src/server.js"]
    }
  }
}
```

Change the path to your real repo location.

Figure 3. TradingView Desktop running with port 9222 active. Once `tv_health_check` returns clean, the bridge can read OHLCV, switch symbols, and pull indicators from this exact chart.

When it breaks (and it might)

Agent can't see MCP tools. Bad JSON in the config, or wrong file location. > Prompt: *"Check my MCP config. Don't change anything without showing me the diff. Find JSON errors, bad repo paths, missing dependencies."*

TradingView won't connect to CDP. Quit every TradingView window. Relaunch through the debug script. Port 9222 must be active locally.

Node is too old. `node -v`. If below 18, update Node.

Pine Script won't compile. Don't guess. Tell Claude: > Prompt: *"Use pine_get_errors and pine_get_console. Explain the compile errors in plain English, then patch only the broken lines."*

CHAPTER

8. Claude vs Codex: Analyst and Technician

Claude is your analyst. Codex is your technician. They are not interchangeable.

	CLAUDE	CODEX
Job	Read the market. Audit your setup. Run the no-trade filter.	Install repos. Read READMEs. Patch the MCP config. Fix Pine errors.
Mental model	Senior risk officer who never gets tired.	Sysadmin who actually reads error messages.
When you use it	Before every trading session. Before every entry. After every loss.	Once during install. When something breaks. When you want to update the repo.
What it never does	Place trades. Predict price. Talk you into a setup.	Make a market decision. Touch your broker. Install random GitHub repos blindly.

A clean Codex prompt has three elements: 1. **What it should do.** 2. **What it should not break.** 3. **How it should confirm the result.**

Example:

```
You are my technical operator. Install the TradingView MCP repo from
https://github.com/tradesdontlie/tradingview-mcp. First read the README, SECURITY
notes,
and package.json. Then install per the repo's instructions. Do not overwrite
existing MCP
config; if a change is needed, show me the exact diff. Finally verify the connection
with
tv_health_check and report the result.
```

That’s the entire art of using Codex.

Plan Mode

When the task might break a working config — *first ask Codex for a plan, not a fix*.

```
First make a plan. Don't edit files yet. Check which config files exist, which repos are
already installed, and which MCP tools are available. Then propose the minimal repair plan.
```

This is how you avoid the agent “helping” too aggressively.

CHAPTER

9. The HTF/LTF Workflow

This is the only workflow you need. Memorize the order. Don't shuffle it.

1. Macro calendar. Are there releases in the next 90 minutes?
2. BTC / ETH / your benchmark instrument — what's the broader risk tone?
3. Read the 1D and 4H structure of your symbol.
4. Mark previous day high/low and previous week high/low.
5. Is price in premium, discount, or near range equilibrium?
6. Drop to 1H and 15M.
7. Look only for setups *aligned with HTF*.
8. Write Scenario A, Scenario B, and the invalidation level for both.

That's it.

Everything else is decoration.

The Operator's vocabulary (this is also the Claude vocabulary)

Use these exact words when you talk to Claude. Mixed terminology produces mixed analysis.

- **OHLCV** — open, high, low, close, volume. The atom of every candle.
- **HTF** — higher timeframe. 1D, 4H, 1H. Context.
- **LTF** — lower timeframe. 15M, 5M, 1M. Entry.
- **Uptrend** — HH and HL. Higher highs and higher lows.
- **Downtrend** — LH and LL.
- **BOS** — Break of Structure. A *closed* candle past prior swing in the direction of trend.
- **CHoCH** — Change of Character. The first close *against* prior structure after a visible reaction off a level.
- **FVG** — Fair Value Gap. An imbalance the market often revisits.
- **Liquidity** — clusters of resting stops and orders. Usually at equal highs/lows.

- **Session range** — the high/low of a specific session. Example: Asia range before London.
- **No trade zone** — middle of a range, no clean structure, news pending, or post-impulse with no logical stop.

The morning protocol (Claude prompt)

```
Run my morning report for [SYMBOL] on TradingView. Start with 1D and 4H: describe the trend,
the last BOS or CHoCH, key swing highs/lows, and the volume context. Then drop to 1H and 15M:
check whether LTF confirms HTF. Give me previous day and previous week high/low. Don't give
me a signal. Give me three scenarios: bullish, bearish, no trade. For each, give the invalidation level.
```

The response should always come back in this format:

- HTF context
- LTF structure
- Key levels
- What confirms the setup
- What invalidates the setup
- Risk and invalidation
- Decision: trade / wait / no trade

Figure 4. BTCUSDT during a morning HTF/LTF read on the 5M, with volume context. The agent works from this exact chart — same symbol, same interval, same data you see.

The word “decision” here doesn’t mean “trade signal.” It means *process decision*: does your own written plan permit further observation?

CHAPTER

10. Price Action Rules for the AI Risk Officer

The agent needs a clear definition of what it's looking for. Otherwise it'll see a BOS in a wick on Tuesday and a CHoCH in the same wick on Wednesday.

Working definitions

- **Valid BOS** — close of a candle past prior swing high (in uptrend) or past prior swing low (in downtrend). Wicks don't count.
- **Valid CHoCH** — first close against prevailing structure *after* a visible reaction off a level. Without the reaction off the level, you're just trading random retracements.
- **Retest** — price returns to the broken level without immediately invalidating the breakout. If it immediately invalidates, it wasn't a breakout — it was a fakeout.
- **No-trade zone** — middle of the range, no clean structure, scheduled macro event in the next 30 minutes, or price already 4R into the move with no logical stop available.

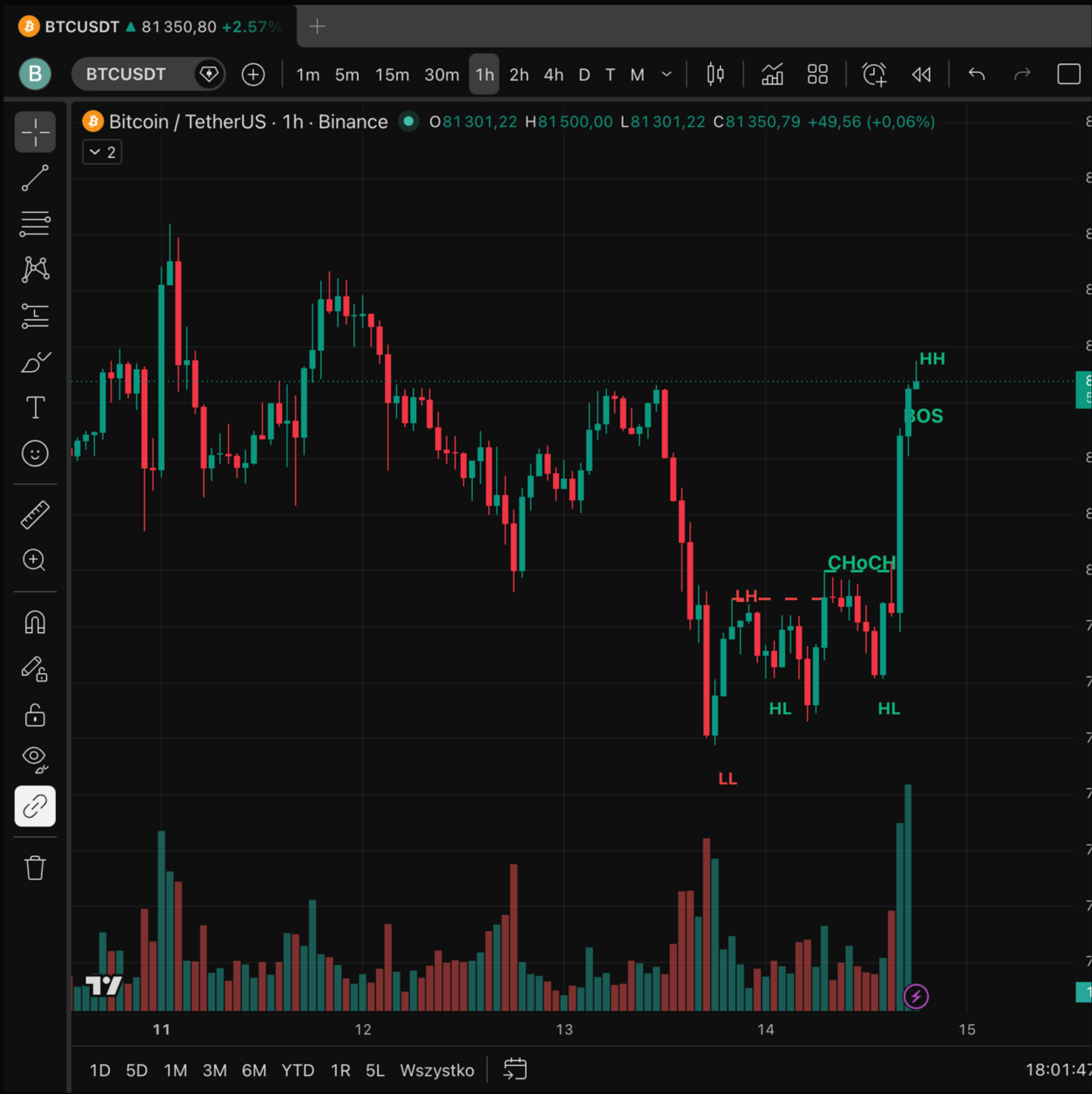

Figure 5. BTCUSDT 1H — a clean CHoCH after a downtrend (LL → LH → HL), followed by a continuation BOS to fresh HH. The kind of readable structure the AI Risk Officer is allowed to trade.

Prompts that enforce the definitions

```
On [SYMBOL] check the most recent BOS and CHoCH. Use candle closes only, not wicks.
Give the
timeframe, the level, the direction, the date/candle, and whether the move had
continuation.
If the structure is unclear, say "no clean structure."
```

```
Mark the key levels for [SYMBOL]: previous day high/low/open/close, previous week
high/low/open/close, last swing high/low on 4H, and equal highs/lows on 1H. Tag each
as
support, resistance, liquidity, or invalidation.
```

```
Check whether the last impulse on [SYMBOL] was supported by volume. Compare the
impulse
volume to the prior 20 candles on the same timeframe. Tell me if the move looks
convincing,
exhausted, or neutral.
```

CHAPTER

11. Levels, Invalidation, and Liquidity

You don’t enter at a “good price.” You enter behind a level.

If you don’t have a level to put your stop behind, you don’t have a trade. You have an opinion.

The four kinds of levels

1. **Support / Resistance** — historic price reactions. Daily and weekly are king.
2. **Liquidity** — equal highs/lows, obvious recent lows, round numbers. This is where stops *are*. The market visits these.
3. **Invalidation** — the level that, if broken, kills your idea. Not “where 1% fits.” The structural line.
4. **Decision zones** — premium and discount halves of the range. Don’t long premium. Don’t short discount.

Equal high/low rule

If the chart has two or three equal lows in a row, the market is going to take them. Don’t be the trader long *above* equal lows. Be the trader watching the sweep and the close back inside.

Operator rule #2

> *No invalidation = no trade. Not “no clear” invalidation. No invalidation. Zero exceptions.*

CHAPTER

12. The Pre-Trade Risk Desk

This is the chapter the gambler skips. Don't skip it.

The risk desk is the chair you sit in for 90 seconds before clicking. The questions you ask. The math you do. The level you check. The reason you decide it's worth the dollar.

A beginner starts with the wrong question: > "What percent of my account should I risk?"

The operator starts with four better questions:

1. Where does this setup stop making sense?
2. Where does my stop loss have to live?
3. Does this entry give a reasonable R:R?
4. Does my position size fit *this stop* — or am I sizing first and stop-hunting second?

Then, and only then, the percent.

The risk arithmetic (in the order it must happen)

```
1.  Define where the setup is invalid.
2.  Place the stop loss behind that level.
3.  Measure the distance: entry → stop.
4.  Calculate the dollar amount of risk you're willing to take.
5.  Adjust position size to fit the stop.
6.  If position size is too small or take-profit is too far, do not force the stop
closer.
    Reject the setup.
```

You never move step 1 to fit step 5. That's the gambler's algorithm.

The Risk Officer prompt

```
Audit the risk of this setup. Direction: [LONG/SHORT]. Entry: [PRICE]. SL: [PRICE].
TP: [PRICE]. Account: [AMOUNT]. Max risk per trade: [PERCENT]. Calculate position
size,
R:R, and tell me whether the SL is logical against structure. If the SL is placed
only
"because that's what fits the percent," flag the setup as weak.
```

Pre-trade checklist

- Do I know the invalidation level?
- Is the SL behind structure, not at a random distance?
- Is the entry chasing a post-impulse move with no retest?
- Does R:R still make sense after spread and commissions?
- Are there any macro releases in the next 60 minutes?
- Do I know what I'll do if price taps TP1?
- Have I accepted the loss *before* clicking?

Six out of seven yes? Wait. Five out of seven? No trade. Below five? Close TradingView.

Figure 6. A long setup with all four legs marked: entry zone, SL behind structure, two TPs (2.1R and 2.5R), and the hard invalidation. Stylized illustration — not a recommendation.

CHAPTER

13. The Challenge Kill Switch

This is the chapter the gambler hates the most.

The kill switch is a hard rule. Not a soft preference. Not a “I’ll see how I feel.” A rule.

When the rule fires, you stop trading. Today is over. Tomorrow is a new day.

The five conditions that trigger the kill switch

1. **You hit 40% of your daily loss limit.** Not 100%. Forty. The other 60% is your buffer for tomorrow’s volatility and your slippage on existing positions.
2. **You took two losing trades in a row.** Two is the signal. Three is the eulogy. Two losses tell you the market is hostile to your read or you are hostile to your process. Either way: stop.
3. **You traded outside your defined session.** You said you only trade the NY open. It’s 1:47 p.m. You’re entering. The setup is irrelevant. The rule was violated. Close the position. Close the laptop.
4. **You moved a stop in the wrong direction.** You widened the stop after entry. The trade is now untracked. Even if it wins, this trade does not exist on your journal. The kill switch fires because the operator just left the building.
5. **You felt the revenge urge.** You know the feeling. The “I have to make this back” feeling. Even if no rule has been violated yet, this is the only emotional signal that always precedes account death. Stop.

The kill switch prompt

```
I'm about to take a trade. Before I do, run the Challenge Kill Switch on me. Ask me:
1) What's my current daily P&L vs daily loss limit?
2) How many losses in a row in the last 60 minutes?
3) Am I inside my defined trading session?
4) Have I moved any stops on open positions?
5) Am I trying to "make back" a loss right now?
If any answer is yes or hostile, write "KILL SWITCH" and tell me to close
TradingView for the
day. If all clear, ask me my setup details and switch to AI Risk Officer mode.
```

The point of this prompt is not to feel good. The point is that you've already pre-committed — *in writing, in front of an audit trail* — to the rule that will save your account.

CHAPTER

14. The Trade / Wait / No Trade Decision

Every report from your AI Risk Officer ends with one of three words.

Trade. Setup is valid. HTF aligned. Stop behind structure. R:R sane. No conflicting macro. You are inside your session. The kill switch is not lit. You may click.

Wait. The setup might exist soon. A confirmation is missing — a candle close, a level retest, a volume signal. Sit on your hands. Set an alert. Walk away from the screen.

No trade. The setup does not exist. HTF is hostile, structure is unclear, news is incoming, the session is over, you are tilted, the daily loss is too close. Do something else with the next 30 minutes.

> *The dream is the trade you don't take. "No trade" is the highest-value output of the entire system. Don't push for "trade."*

CHAPTER

15. Failed Challenge Autopsy

You already blew at least one. Maybe four. Probably more.

Each one of them died for a reason. You probably don't know the reason — you know the *narrative* you told yourself afterward. "Market was weird that day." "Spread was crazy." "Got stop-hunted." Those aren't reasons. Those are stories.

The autopsy is how you find the actual reason. Then you put the actual reason on the no-trade list, in writing, before the next challenge.

The five categories of failure

1. **Strategy** — you took a setup that wasn't in your plan.
2. **Timing** — you took a setup at the wrong time (post-impulse chase, outside session, before macro).
3. **Risk** — your position size was wrong, your SL was random, your R:R didn't survive costs.
4. **Emotion** — revenge entry, FOMO entry, "I deserve this" entry, the after-Discord entry.
5. **Rule violation** — you broke a prop firm rule (max contracts, news window, lot size, weekend hold).

Almost every blown account is a combination of two of these. Usually 4 + 3.

The autopsy prompt

```
Audit my failed challenge without making excuses for me. Here are the trades that
killed it:
[paste trades or summary]. Categorize each trade by:
- strategy error (yes/no, what)
- timing error
- risk error
- emotional error
- rule violation
For each category, give me one lesson and one rule for my next challenge. Don't give
me
motivation. Don't tell me I'll do better next time. Give me the rule.
```

Composite example: A trader I'll call "Daniel" ran his autopsy on a $50K account that died Tuesday at 11:14 a.m. EST. He thought it died because of a CPI release. The autopsy showed every trade after the second loss was a revenge entry, all sized 2× his original plan, all entered before the actual release. The CPI was not the cause. The 8:31 a.m. revenge was. He added "no trade for 60 minutes after any loss" to his rules. He still blew the next account too — old habits — but the one after that finished. Composite example. Your mileage will vary.

CHAPTER

16. The Payout-Ready Routine

You don't pass a challenge by trying harder.

You pass by behaving like the version of yourself who already passed one.

That trader has a routine. Five blocks. None of them are optional.

Pre-session (the desk warm-up)

- Macro calendar. Anything in the next 4 hours?
- Read benchmark (BTC, ES, DXY — whatever your primary is).
- Read your symbol on 1D and 4H. Mark levels.
- Read 1H and 15M structure.
- Write Scenario A, Scenario B, and the invalidation for both.
- Set your daily loss soft limit (40%) and hard limit (the firm's actual number).

Pre-trade (the risk desk)

- Run the Risk Officer prompt.
- Confirm SL is behind structure.
- Confirm R:R survives costs.
- Confirm no macro release in the trade window.
- Run the Kill Switch.
- Accept the loss in advance. Out loud.
- Click.

Post-loss

- Close the chart for at least 20 minutes.
- Do not look at the symbol.

- Do not “check if it would’ve worked.”
- Run the Post-Loss prompt: log the trade, categorize the error, name the lesson.
- Return only if all kill-switch conditions remain clear.

Post-session

- Two trades a day is plenty.
- Close TradingView no matter what at the end of your session.
- Log every trade (including no-trades, including respected waits).
- One sentence: what did the operator do well today?

Between challenges

- Read the autopsy of the last one.
- Update your no-trade list.
- Do not reset until the autopsy is complete.
- The next fee won’t fix the same behavior.

> *Operator rule #3: Payout starts before the entry. It starts at the desk warm-up. It starts at the first “no trade.” It ends at “I respected the rule even though I was right.”*

CHAPTER

17. Pine Script and Automation

Pine Script is not for predicting the market.

Pine Script is for turning your rules into an objective test.

If your rule is “I only enter on a BOS retest with a 2R minimum,” Pine Script can mark it on the chart and run it across the last 1,000 candles. Now you can see whether your rule actually has an edge, or whether you’ve been pattern-matching your own memory.

The order, every time

1. Describe the logic in plain English.
2. Generate the code.
3. Compile.
4. Patch only the broken lines.

Never the reverse. Don’t start with code.

Three useful prompts

Levels indicator:

```
Write Pine Script v6 that draws previous day high/low and previous week high/low on
the
chart. Add labels, configurable colors, and an alertcondition when price touches a
level.
Code must be readable. No repainting. After pasting into Pine Editor, compile and
fix
errors.
```

Structure detection:

```
Write Pine Script v6 to mark swing high/low, BOS, and CHoCH. Only count BOS on a
close
beyond the most recent swing. Add swing length options, labels, and alerts. Do not
claim
this perfectly detects price action — treat it as a visual aid.
```

Strategy backtest:

```
Convert my logic into a Pine Script v6 strategy: enter only on BOS, retest of the
level,
confirmation by candle close. Stop loss behind the last swing. Take profit at 2R.
Include
commissions, slippage, and a date range limit. After compiling, tell me what the
strategy
tests and what it does not test.
```

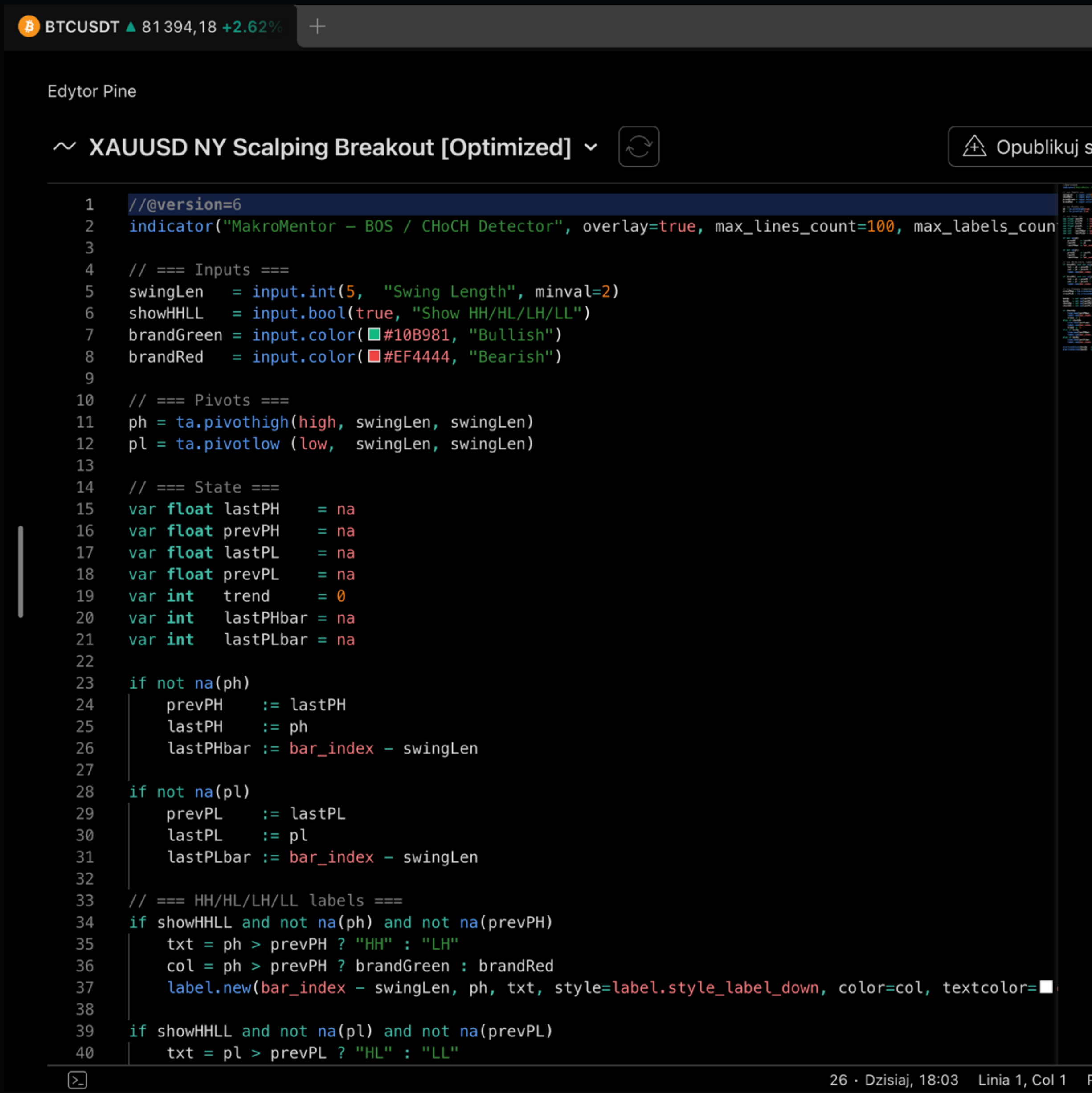

Figure 7. Pine Editor with a compiled v6 script. Claude reads the editor console directly through MCP — no copy-paste of error messages.

After the code is generated

- Does it compile?
- Pine Script v6?
- No repainting?
- Signals confirm at candle close, not intra-candle?
- Alerts trigger when you expect?
- Is the stop loss logical?

- Does the backtest include costs?
- Is the strategy curve-fit to one chart, or does it generalize?

If the answers feel rehearsed, you're not done.

CHAPTER

18. The 7-Day Challenge Prep Plan

Read this on a Sunday. Start on a Monday. Don't trade live before Day 7.

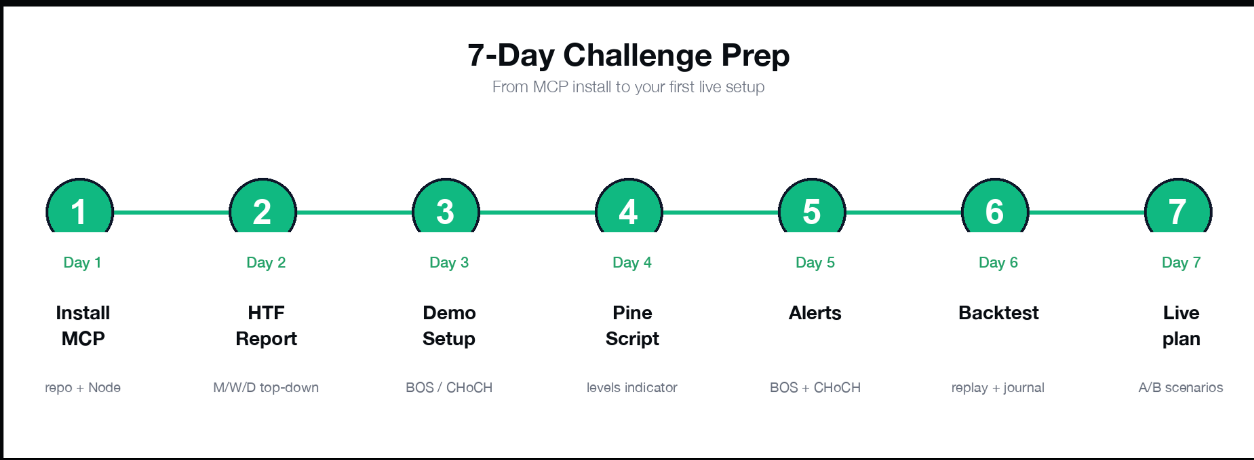

Figure 8. From MCP install on Day 1 to a live plan on Day 7. Each day has exactly one job. Skip none.

Day 1 — Install

Install TradingView MCP using one of the three paths. Do not analyze the market today. Run `tv_health_check` until it returns clean. That's the whole day.

Day 2 — Read only

Ask Claude to read the current chart state, OHLCV, and take a screenshot. Don't change any scripts. Don't run any analysis prompts. Just confirm the bridge sees what you see.

Day 3 — First HTF/LTF report

Run the morning report prompt on one symbol. Compare Claude's read with your own. Write down where you agreed and where you disagreed.

Day 4 — Levels

Mark previous day and previous week levels. Ask Claude to mark them too. Compare. Don't trade. Don't even think about trading.

Day 5 — The Risk Officer

Pick one *hypothetical* setup. Run the Risk Officer prompt with fake numbers. Read the output. Then run the Kill Switch. Then accept "no trade" as a valid outcome.

Day 6 — No-trade simulation

Open TradingView during your usual session. Pick three setups that look "decent." Run the Risk Officer on all three. If any return "no trade," write down why. Walk away. You took zero positions today. Notice how you feel.

Day 7 — Journal and rules

Summarize the week. Keep only the prompts that actually changed something. Write your no-trade list. Write your kill switch conditions on paper, in the same handwriting you used to write your first business plan. Tape it above the monitor.

Now you're allowed to trade live next week. Small size. Real rules. AI Risk Officer between every click.

CHAPTER

19. The Prompt Pack (overview)

The full set of named prompts lives in `02_prompt_pack.md`. The ten protocols:

1. **AI Risk Officer** — the master pre-trade audit.
2. **Challenge Kill Switch** — the hard stop conditions.
3. **Failed Challenge Autopsy** — what actually killed the last one.
4. **Post-Loss Protocol** — what to do in the 60 minutes after a red trade.
5. **NY Session Prep** — the desk warm-up before the open.
6. **No-Trade Filter** — six questions, one verdict.
7. **Daily Loss Defense** — soft and hard limit math.
8. **HTF/LTF Full Report** — the morning structural read.
9. **Pine Script Level Builder** — automate the level marks.
10. **Trading Journal Operator** — the post-session log that won't lie to you.

Each prompt in the pack has a name, when to use it, the full text, expected output structure, and a warning/limitation block.

CHAPTER

20. Final Rules Before Buying Another Challenge

If you remember nothing else from this book, remember the seven below. Tape them above the monitor.

1. **No process, no trade.** Your ego wants the trade. Your process gets the final vote.
2. **No invalidation, no trade.** No level behind the stop = no trade. Zero exceptions.
3. **Size from the stop. Never the stop from the size.** This is the entire game.
4. **The daily loss soft limit is 40%.** When you hit it, you're done for the day.
5. **Two losses in a row, the laptop closes.** Two is the signal. Three is the eulogy.
6. **No revenge entry inside 60 minutes of a loss.** This is the rule that saves the account.
7. **No new challenge until the last one has been autopsied.** The next fee won't fix the same behavior.

Print this page. Tape it up. If you can't honestly look at it before you buy your next challenge, don't buy the challenge yet.

The dream is not the payout. The dream is the trader you'd have to be to deserve one.

CHAPTER

21. Sources and Tools

These are the canonical links for the open-source pieces of the stack. Bookmark them. They get updated.

- **Claude Desktop & Claude Code** — `claude.ai/download`
- **OpenAI Codex Help** — `https://help.openai.com/en/articles/11369540-codex-in-chatgpt`
- **Model Context Protocol (spec)** — `https://github.com/modelcontextprotocol/modelcontext-protocol`
- **MCP Apps** — `https://github.com/modelcontextprotocol/ext-apps`
- **MCP Conformance** — `https://github.com/modelcontextprotocol/conformance`
- **MCP Registry** — `https://github.com/modelcontextprotocol/registry`
- **TradingView MCP Bridge** — `https://github.com/tradesdontlie/tradingview-mcp`
- **TradingView Desktop** — install from `tradingview.com/desktop/`
- **Pine Script v6 docs** — `https://www.tradingview.com/pine-script-docs/`

> *The repos are open source. They evolve. Read the README before every fresh install. Read the SECURITY notes before you give Claude tool access on your machine.*

CHAPTER

22. Bonuses / Next Products

This book is the foundation. The next steps deepen the system in specific places.

Bonus 1 — The Operator's Journal Template

A printable PDF journal with the trade log fields built around the AI Risk Officer's output. Eight columns. Fits one trade per row. Reads like a flight log.

Bonus 2 — The 30-Day Operator Reset

A 30-day calendar designed for traders who just blew an account and need a structured way back. Not a course. A calendar. Days 1–7: autopsy and no trading. Days 8–14: paper rebuild. Days 15–30: small-size challenge prep.

Bonus 3 — The Kill Switch Card (free download)

A wallet-sized PDF with the five kill switch conditions printed on one side and the seven final rules on the other. Tape one above the monitor. Carry one in your wallet. Sounds dumb. Works.

Next product — *AI Risk Officer Pro* (coming)

A deeper module that includes a structured operator's playbook for: pre-funded prep, in-challenge management, post-payout discipline, and the failed-challenge return protocol. For traders who want this system to be the only system they ever run.

Final disclaimer

This playbook is educational. It is not financial advice, investment advice, a signal service, or a guarantee of trading results. Trading and funded challenges involve risk. You are responsible for your own decisions, risk, and compliance with prop firm rules.

End of book.